PRODUCT LENS

Zomato Group Ordering

Solving what matters most: closing the payment and budget gap in group food ordering

SUBMITTED BY

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Project Enhancing group food ordering in Zomato
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At a Glance

Problem	Group orders still end with one person paying for everyone and chasing friends for money.
Insight	Zomato already has a shared cart (Aug 2024). The gap is split payment, budget visibility and per-person attribution.
Solution	Group Ordering 2.0: pay-your-share, live budget view and cart enhancements. AI meal suggestions come later.
Opportunity	About ₹0.56 crore per month in the base case (illustrative), plus higher order frequency and retention.
One metric	Group order completion rate (paid and placed).
Next step	Test a Figma prototype with 10 students and 10 office employees.

1. Product Selected: Zomato

Zomato is one of India's leading food delivery platforms. It lets users order food, discover restaurants, reserve tables and access dining services. I selected it because it is used widely by students, professionals and families, which makes real user pain points easy to identify.

Market context (2026)

Food delivery is now a large and profitable business for Zomato's parent, Eternal. The numbers below come from Eternal's and Swiggy's quarterly shareholder letters and press coverage of them.

Metric	Latest reported figure
Average monthly transacting customers, food delivery	27.2 million in Q1 FY27; 28 million in Q2 FY27
Food delivery net order value (Q1 FY27)	₹10,769 crore, up 20.1% year on year
Adjusted EBITDA (Q1 FY27)	₹606 crore, 5.6% of net order value
Net average order value (Q2 FY27)	About ₹525
Active restaurant partners	About 3.3 lakh
Zomato's share of food delivery gross order value	More than 58% (Q1 FY27)
Swiggy monthly transacting users (Q1 FY27)	19.2 million

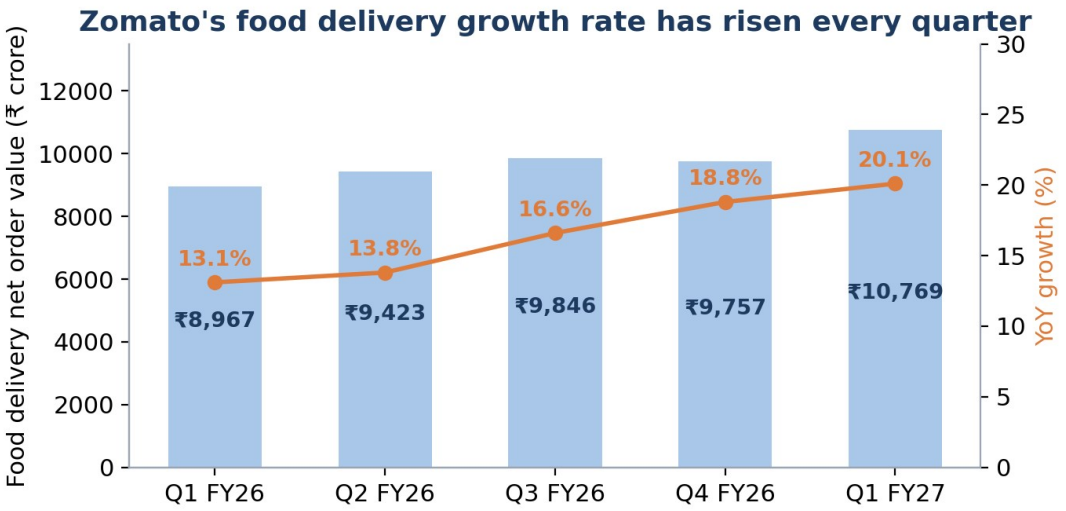
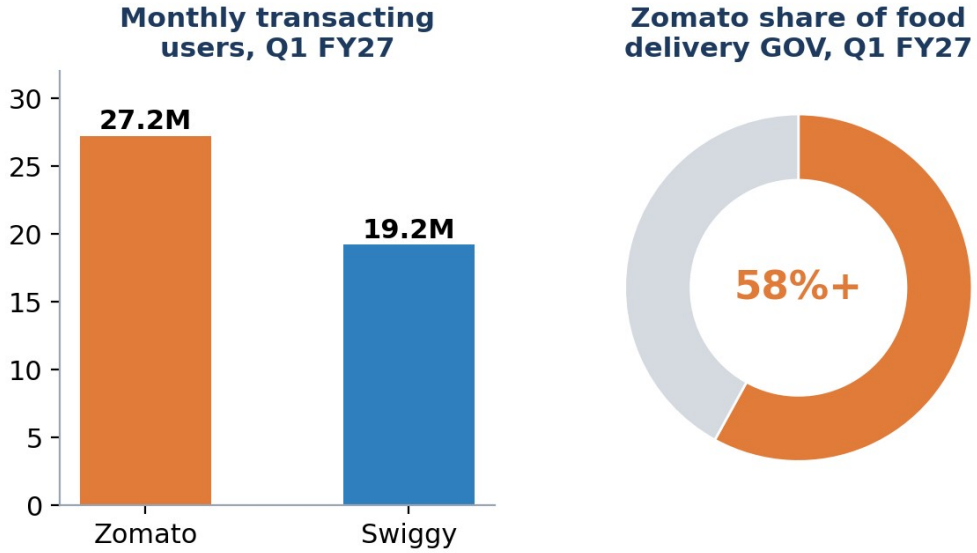


Figure 1. *Zomato food delivery net order value and year-on-year growth by quarter (Eternal shareholder letters).*



Sources: Eternal and Swiggy Q1 FY27 shareholder letters; Business Standard (Aug 2026).

Figure 2. *Zomato and Swiggy compared on monthly transacting users and Zomato's share of gross order value.*

Growth is now driven by more customers ordering more often. In a market this large, even a small improvement to a common behaviour, such as ordering together, can add up quickly.

2. Problem Statement

When people order food as a group, everyone has different tastes, budgets and dietary needs. Typically one person places the order and then chases everyone for their choices and, afterwards, for their share of the money. This takes time and often leads to wrong or incomplete orders and awkward payment follow-ups.

Where it happens

- Office lunches
- Family dinners
- College group meals
- Weekend parties

Current issues

- Confusion over who ordered what
- Manual payment collection and reminders
- Last-minute changes to the order
- Missed items
- Longer ordering time

3. Where Zomato Stands Today: Gap Analysis

Zomato introduced a Group Ordering feature in August 2024. Users share a link or QR code, everyone adds items to a single cart from their own phone, and one person checks out and pays. News reports at launch described a 30-minute window to complete the order and a cap of 30 people per group; these limits may have changed since. Swiggy launched a similar feature earlier, and Zomato has separately introduced a “large order fleet” for group, party or event orders of up to 50 people.

This means a shared cart already exists. The project therefore focuses on what is still missing: the payment, budget and fairness layer around the shared cart.

Capability	Available today	Gap
Shared cart via link or QR	Yes	Limited visibility of who added what; limited time to finish
Payment	One person pays the full bill	No in-app way to split or collect each person’s share
Budget awareness	No	Nobody can see their running spend or set a cap
Dietary and preference awareness	Basic filters	No group-level suggestions that fit everyone
Very large events	Large order fleet for up to 50 people	Not the everyday 3 to 10 person order this project targets

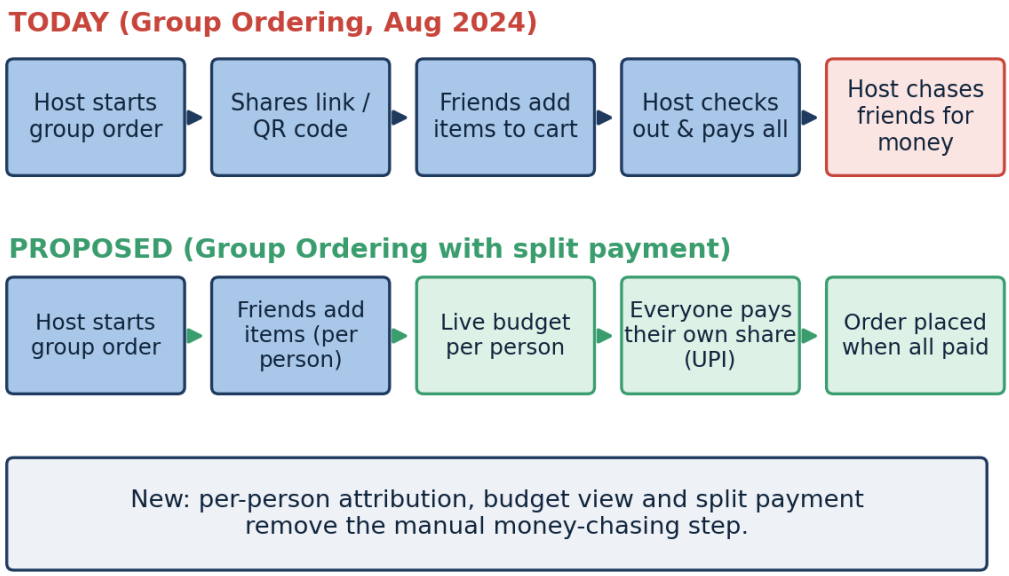


Figure 3. *Group ordering today compared with the proposed flow with per-person attribution, budget view and split payment.*

> **Verify before submission:** check the current Zomato app to confirm exactly what Group Ordering supports today, and update this table if needed.

Opportunity sizing (bottom-up, illustrative)

The estimates below are assumptions for educational purposes, not company data. The base case uses Eternal's reported 28 million average monthly transacting customers (Q2 FY27) rather than a larger "active users" figure, because the revenue is earned per order in a given month.

Assumption	Value
Average monthly transacting customers (food delivery)	28 million (reported, Q2 FY27)
Customers placing a group order in a month	20% (5.6 million), assumed
Year-1 adoption of the new feature	10% (0.56 million), assumed
Incremental service revenue per split-payment order	₹10 (about 2% of a ₹525 order), assumed
Split-payment orders per adopting customer per month	1, assumed

> *5,600,000 × 10% × ₹10 = ₹5.6 million (₹0.56 crore) per month, or about ₹6.7 crore per year.*

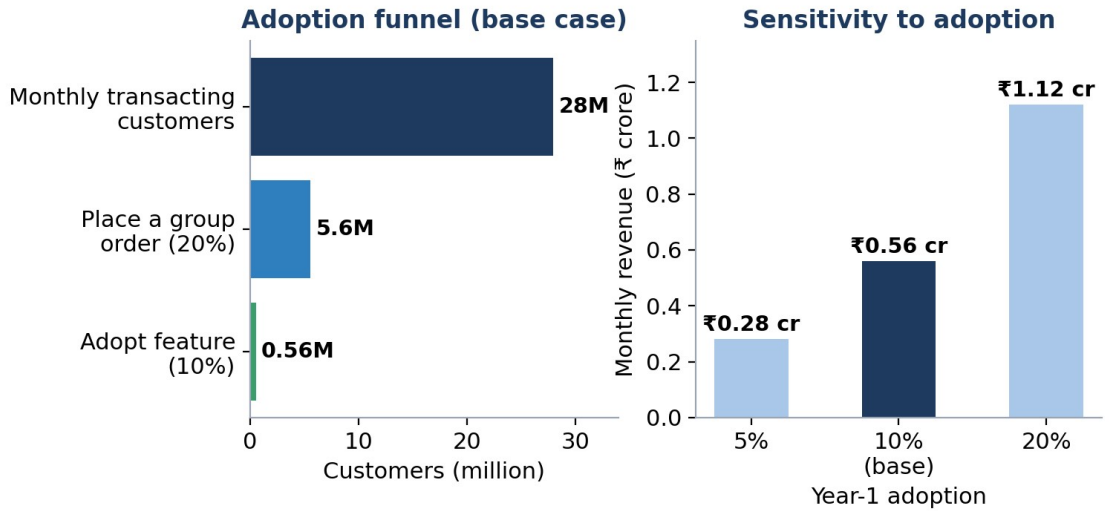


Figure 4. *Adoption funnel for the base case and sensitivity of monthly revenue to Year-1 adoption.*

> **Change from the first draft:** the earlier version assumed 80 million active users and ₹1.6 crore per month. That figure treated a large annual user base as if everyone ordered in the same month, so the base case now uses the reported monthly figure. If the larger 80 million base is used instead, the same assumptions give ₹1.6 crore per month.

The direct revenue is modest, so the stronger case for the feature is strategic: it removes friction from a very common behaviour, which supports order frequency, basket size and retention, and it makes Zomato harder to switch away from for groups, where the person who hosts the order tends to choose the app.

4. Proposed Features

Feature	Description
Split payment	Each participant pays their own share (for example by UPI) from the shared order link; live status of who has paid.
Cart enhancements	Per-person item attribution, a longer ordering window, and reminders for people who have not added items.
Budget tracker	Shows each person's running spend in real time, with an optional per-person cap.
AI meal suggestions	Recommendations that respect group preferences and dietary needs (for example veg-only or allergies).

5. RICE Prioritisation

RICE score = (Reach × Impact × Confidence) ÷ Effort. Reach, Impact and Confidence are scored 1–10 and Effort is in relative person-months. The scores are team estimates for the purpose of ranking.

Feature	Reach	Impact	Confidence	Effort	RICE score
Split payment	8	8	8	3	171
Cart enhancements	7	6	8	2	168

Feature	Reach	Impact	Confidence	Effort	RICE score
Budget tracker	7	7	8	3	131
AI meal suggestions	6	7	7	5	59

The basic shared cart is not scored because it already exists; it is the baseline the new features build on.

Priority order

1. Split payment
2. Cart enhancements
3. Budget tracker
4. AI meal suggestions

The first two features solve the core remaining pain point and deliver the most value for the effort.

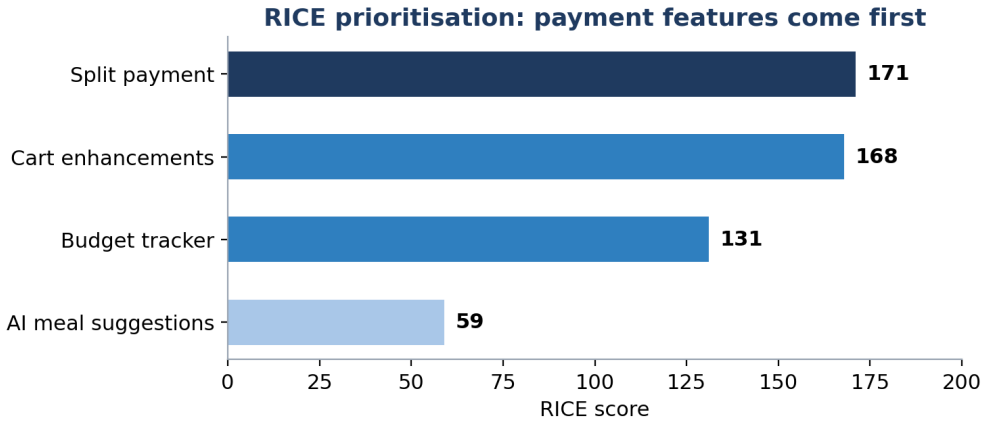


Figure 5. *RICE scores of the proposed features.*

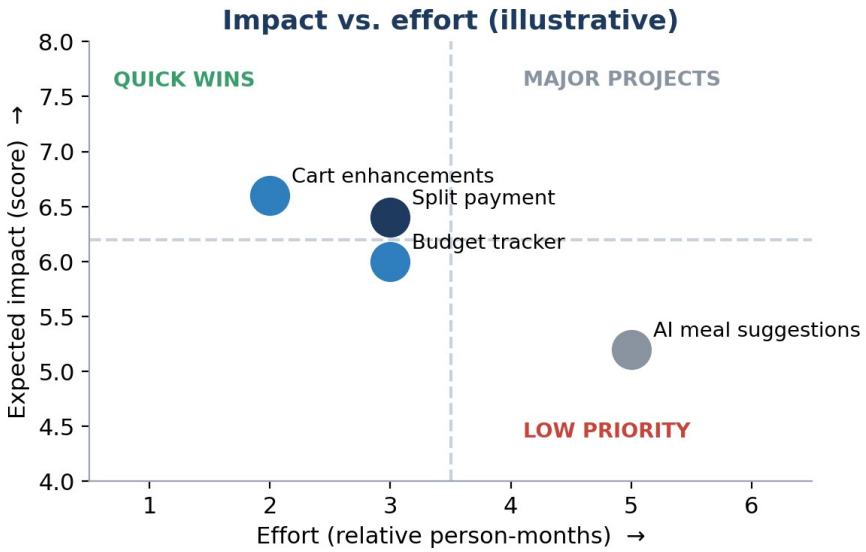


Figure 6. *Impact versus effort (illustrative). Split payment and cart enhancements are the quick wins.*

6. MoSCoW Prioritisation

Category	Features
Must have	Split payment; per-person item attribution
Should have	Budget tracker; longer ordering window with reminders
Could have	AI meal suggestions
Won't have (MVP)	Group voting on restaurants; loyalty rewards for group orders; in-app social chat

The "won't have" items are excluded on purpose so the first release stays focused and easy to validate.

7. Kano Framework

Feature	Category	Reason
Shared cart (existing)	Basic need	Users now expect group ordering to work smoothly.
Split payment	Performance feature	The easier payment is, the higher the satisfaction.
AI meal suggestions	Delighter	Personalised group recommendations create a differentiated experience.

8. Minimum Viable Product

The MVP includes only the essentials on top of the existing shared cart:

- Per-person item attribution in the shared cart
- Pay-your-share option for each participant
- Live payment status for the group
- Rule for unpaid shares (the host covers the balance or the order is held)
- Order confirmation to all participants

> *Core value: allow a group to order together and pay fairly, with no manual coordination or chasing for money.*

MVP validation plan

Create a clickable Figma prototype and test it with 10 college students and 10 office employees. Each participant completes a mock group order.

Success criteria:

- At least 80% complete the task without assistance.
- Average ordering and payment time falls by at least 30% compared with the current flow.
- At least 80% say they would use the feature again.

9. One Metric That Matters (OMTM)

Group order completion rate: the percentage of group orders that are successfully paid and placed after being started.

A high completion rate shows the feature is useful, intuitive and valuable. Supporting guardrail metrics are time to complete an order, share of orders where all participants paid their own share, and the cancellation or dispute rate.

10. Risks

Risk	Mitigation
Participants do not pay their share	Clear host fallback; reminders; optional pre-payment before the order is placed
Payment complexity and compliance	Use existing UPI and payment gateway rails; follow RBI and payment-aggregator rules
Restaurant minimum order values and delivery fees	Show per-person fee allocation transparently
Feature adds friction for small groups	Keep split payment optional; default to single-payer
Competitor response (Swiggy has a similar group order feature)	Differentiate on payment, budget and dietary intelligence, not just the shared cart

11. Expected Business Impact

For users	For Zomato
Faster ordering **Reduced confusion** **Easier payment** **A better group experience**	Higher engagement More frequent orders Better customer retention Higher average order value Stronger competitive differentiation

Next Steps

When	Action	Output
Week 1	Verify what Group Ordering supports today and review user feedback on it.	Confirmed gap analysis
Weeks 2–3	Build and test the split-payment prototype with 20 participants.	Task success, time saved and willingness to reuse
Weeks 4–8	Launch a limited A/B test in two cities for split payment and per-person attribution.	Group order completion rate vs. control
Month 3	Review the metric and the unpaid-share rate; decide on budget tracker and AI suggestions.	Scale-up decision

Conclusion

Zomato's shared cart already solves half of the group ordering problem. The remaining friction is in paying fairly and staying within budget. By focusing the MVP on split payment and cart enhancements, Zomato can validate demand quickly, learn from real usage, and later add budget tracking and AI-based recommendations.

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- Assignment brief: Product Lens: Solving What Matters Most requirements.
- Market sizing and prioritisation scores are illustrative estimates for educational purposes.